

chemical factories and immediately halted shipments to Czechoslovakia.

The new combine, however, was but a fraction of the spoils. Not only could huge quantities of explosives be produced in its factories, but as von Schnitzler had admitted in 1945: "By this theft, I.G. took DONAU-CHEMIE (the combine) as an 'overcoat' to run other Austrian plants in the dam area of Moosbierbaum."

With the Commercial Committee and Ilgner's office, Ilgner and Haeffliger had planned the original conquest. Now, the VW office stepped in. With the assistance of the Wehrmacht, the VW projected a program of new investments in Austria totaling RM 192,000,000. Unknown to the World War I allies, new works were built at Moosbierbaum for producing high octane gasoline I and II (which had been handed to Farben by Standard Oil and the U.S. War Department), sulfuric acid (for nitrates), "nebellacid," magnesium and chlorine. Metals, liquids, and explosives: ^{THESE WERE} the spoils of the first unknown conquest in an undeclared war. von Schnitzler described it happily to his colleagues as the fulfillment of "a long cherished plan of uniting the chemical industry of Austria."